

Person Centered Planning for Students in the CrossingPoints Certificate in Occupational Studies
(CCOS) Program

Background:

While there are many choices of tools for Person Centered Planning (PCP), many of them rely on some other person/s completing the plan on behalf of the person with a disability. The CrossingPoints approach to PCP is an adapted version of the Making Action Plans (MAPS) model of PCP which allows the student not only to be at the center, but to be the spokesperson of their desired future in all the essential areas of transition including, postsecondary education, independent living, leisure/recreation, community access and participation, and employment. By removing the complexities of many other traditional PCP planning instruments, we ensure that the PCP is accessible to and by the student and they can present it to their circle of supports in their own words/in their own way. Our approach allows the student's voice to be the voice that speaks. We believe that this nurtures the students' autonomy as evidenced in the information they choose to share at the PCP. For example, in the academic domain, while students are required to highlight the classes they have successfully completed, they are not necessarily required to include grades, thus, many of them choose to omit that information during their PCP. The same holds true across other domains as well.

Many traditional PCP instruments are undergirded by a theoretical assumption that people with disabilities are not qualified to decide for themselves how they want to spend their lives; hence planning is done for them or with them rather than BY them. This notion, if applied to anyone else, would be rejected immediately as contrary to the American values of freedom and liberty. Our approach to PCP, therefore, is premised on supporting the student in articulating their dream futures without us attempting to "fix" those dreams but recognizing that as the student's repertoire of life experiences increases, their dream future also changes to reflect said growth. We do not want the PCP to become another Individualized Education Program that was written for them by a committee.

Overview:

There are many methods to use when working with individuals with disabilities in planning for their future. One such method, and the one used by the CrossingPoints Program at The University of Alabama, is the Person-Centered Planning (PCP) approach. There are many models of PCP. CrossingPoints uses an adapted version of the Making Action Plans (MAPS) model of PCP. MAPS is a tool that uses both process and graphic facilitation to create *a shared vision of a positive future for individuals and families*. The student's PCP team uses a person-centered

approach in which the plans for the future are built upon the student's dreams, fears, interests, and needs. MAPS draws on the PCP team's ability to visualize different futures and to plan for these using the focus person's unique gifts, strengths, interests and capacities.

The critical steps to PCP as practiced in the CrossingPoints program are:

1. Fully getting to know the student across environments.
2. Supporting the student in constructing a team that will help develop a comprehensive profile and support them in specific ways throughout a lifetime.
3. Implement a clear, unrestricted dream of future success that will guide the action plans. This includes the student's strengths and preferences.

Person-Centered Planning begins by getting to know the student across all settings, including inclusive UA academic courses, CrossingPoints Program (CPP) specialized courses, employment internships, social activities, etc. We support the student to establish a network or "circle" of people who participate in the student's PCP. This circle or network consists of those who know and have a vested interest in the student's success now and in the future. This team of supporters is from varied backgrounds bringing with it connections to support the student in creating a dream with no boundaries. The makeup of the team is left to the discretion of the student and may include family, friends, peers, mentors, job supervisors, previous teachers, clergy, etc. A facilitator (generally the CCOS Program Faculty) coordinates the process of who will provide data, make records, utilize graphics, and bring it together to establish and promote, and capture the student's ultimate dreams of their desired future in the five transition essential areas of transition (postsecondary education, independent living, leisure/recreation, community access and participation, and employment). The facilitator's role is also to ensure that the student's voice is heard all through the process and is not overshadowed by well-meaning voices that may not necessarily reflect the student's own.

The student drives the entire process through the support of program staff. They select the time and location for meetings and who is invited. No restrictions are made on what is deemed relevant content in meetings; however, some specific content must be covered (as outlined in the section below). When the dreams of future success have been achieved, the final step is to develop flexible ongoing action plans and community support through open forums and brainstorming. The facilitator encourages the student to lead this process with his/her supports. The facilitator organizes the ideas brought forth in the brainstorming into a fully developed short-term action plan.

Steps in Person-Centered Planning in CCOS:

1. Get to know the student across setting and by utilizing the PCP Dream Sheet. As people and dreams change over time, so these processes are completed each year in the program.
2. Teach the student what Person-Centered Planning is, including the purpose, the process, and the goals of person-centered planning.
3. Support the student in reflecting on their progress in previous short-term goals, brainstorming ideas about their future, and reflecting/redefining their long-term goals. Once long-term goals have been established/re-established, support the student in drafting

more specific short-term goals (these will be presented to their team in the PCP meeting and discussed before finalizing).

4. Support the student in creating their PCP presentation. Presentations can be in any format the student chooses. Some examples are PowerPoint presentation, storybook, Road Map for the future, song, etc. Again, no restrictions are made on what is deemed relevant content in meetings, but some specific topics MUST be included (see Required Content section below).
5. Support the student in brainstorming who should be invited. There should be some critical people invited to every meeting and maybe some who only come once or twice along the way.
6. Support the student in presenting their presentation during the meeting and facilitate the discussion, encouraging all members to contribute. Additionally, the facilitator takes notes from the meeting and combines ideas to develop a detailed action plan using the CrossingPoints PCP Notes Form (in Qualtrics). Each team member has a role in the plan in supporting the student to achieve their short- and long-term goals. The action plan also includes dates for review to ensure that the student stays on track in working toward their goals.
7. PCP notes are taken in real time and reviewed at the end of the meeting, while all participants are present to ensure agreement on the action plan. Immediately following the meeting, PCP notes are emailed to all team members. This is particularly important as it ensures those team members who have specific roles in supporting the student in implementing the action plan receive the notes while the meeting is still fresh in their minds.
8. Following the meeting, the student is supported in sending a thank-you email to all attendees and attaching the action plan that was developed during the PCP meeting for the team to review.

Required Content in CCOS PCPs:

- Introductions
- Description of Self
- Strengths and Preferences
- Potential Challenges
- Future Goals (Focus on One-At-A-Time)
 - Employment
 - Living Situation
 - Socially
 - Academically
 - Leisure/Rec
 - Community Participation
- Review of Previous Short-Term Goals and Progress
- Review of Courses Taken
- Discussion of Courses for the Upcoming Semester
- Discussion of Short-Term Goals and Action Plan for Moving Ahead

Timeline for PCPs in CCOS:

- August-September: Complete Yearly Dream Sheets
- Prior to Registration (Usually in February- mid March): PCP Meeting.

The PCP meetings for first year and second year students must be completed before Fall course registration in order to ensure that courses recommended by the PCP team are considered at registration. For graduating classmen, PCP meetings may be held later in the semester (late March-April). The PCP meeting for this group should focus on developing goals and action plans for post-college goals in the five areas of transition (postsecondary education, independent living, leisure/recreation, community access and participation, and employment). At this stage, the PCP Team members should include individuals who will continue to support the student beyond college.

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College of
Education

Default Question Block

Meeting Notes

Student Name

*IMPORTANT NOTE: Be sure to use the student's Legal Name (First and Last Name Only) and make sure to use appropriate capitalization and spelling. **Names MUST match from semester to semester for analysis purposes.*

Indicate the Current Semester

- ☐ Fall
- ☐ Spring
- ☐ Summer

Indicate the Current Year

Enter a date:

← February 2023 →

Su	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa
29	30	31	1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11



People in Attendance:

	Name	Role	Email
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			

Meeting Notes

Long Term Goals

Employment

Living Arrangements

Social

Academic

Leisure/Recreation

Community
Participation

Action Plan:

Employment Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Employment Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8/ChoiceTextEntryValue/i\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			

Living Arrangements Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Living Arrangements Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8$

$/ChoiceTextEntryValue/2\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			

Social Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Social Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8/ChoiceTextEntryValue/3\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			

Academic Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Academic Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8/ChoiceTextEntryValue/4\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			

Leisure/Recreation Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Leisure/Recreation Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8$

$/ChoiceTextEntryValue/5\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			

Community Participation Short Term Goals:

$\$ \{q://QID2/ChoiceTextEntryValue\}$'s Community Participation Long Term Goal: $\$ \{q://QID8$

$/ChoiceTextEntryValue/6\}$

	Goal	Person(s) Responsible	Date to Be Completed
Short Term Goal #1			
Short Term Goal #2			
Short Term Goal #3			